

Assurance Of Salvation

doc-assurance-of-salvation

Soteriology · Assurance · doctrine · unanimous_lineages

AFFIRMS

score 1.000
confidence high

Statement under examination

Believers may have well-grounded assurance of salvation, founded on the promises of God in Christ, the inward witness of the Spirit, and the evidence of Spirit-wrought fruit.

In plain language

The verses cited point one way. In 1 John 5:13 the writer states his purpose with hina eidete, built on the word for purpose plus oida, a verb of settled knowing (here a perfect-stem form, confirmed by querying the text), and his goal is that people who believe may KNOW they HAVE eternal life right now, using present-tense possession. That is assurance grounded in a promise. In 2 Timothy 1:12 the same verb appears as oida, I know whom I have believed, the personal form of that knowledge. In Romans 8:16 the verb symmartyrei means the Spirit bears witness together WITH our spirit that we are children of God. That verb occurs only three times in the whole New Testament and always means a joint, co-attesting testimony, so it names a genuinely inward ground, the witness of the Spirit. Romans 5:1-5 starts from having been justified, which yields peace toward God, then builds a chain: pressure produces endurance, endurance produces proven character, and proven character produces hope, a hope that does not put us to shame because the love of God has been poured out in our hearts. The word for proven character describes tested, demonstrated genuineness, the third ground, fruit worked by the Spirit. Hebrews 10:22 names full assurance of faith outright, a word that means complete certainty and appears only four times, and ties it to a heart already sprinkled and washed. Second Peter 1:10 tells believers to make their calling and election firm, a word that means guaranteed. One verse pulls the other way: Second Corinthians 13:5 commands examine yourselves, using the same root that elsewhere means proven, and warns of being disqualified. But that command tests a reality, it does not deny that assurance exists. So across an apostle, two letters of Paul, and Hebrews the same picture holds: believers may rest in a confidence anchored in the promise, the Spirit's witness, and visible fruit. What the words do not settle is which of those three grounds weighs most, or whether assurance is built into faith from the start or grows as a separate confidence over time. That open question, not any doubt about whether assurance exists, is where careful readers honestly diverge. The pattern is consistent and the verdict affirms the proposition.

Word dictionary

Every Hebrew and Greek word this study leans on, in everyday terms. Shaded rows are the anchor words the verdict rests on.

Strong	Word	Sounds like	Plain meaning	Times in Bible
G0026	ἀγάπη	agape	love	116
G0096	ἀδόκιμος	adokimos	failing	
G0166	αἰώνιος	aionios	eternal	69
G0228	ἀληθινός	alethinos	true	28
G0949	βέβαιος	bebaios	firm	8
G1097	γινώσκω	ginōskō	to know	
G1344	δικαίω	dikaioo	to justify	39

G1381	δοκιμάζω	dokimazō	to test	
G1382	δοκιμή	dokime	test	7
G1492	οἶδα	oida	to perceive	293
G1515	εἰρήνη	eirene	peace	91
G1680	ἐλπίς	elpis	hope	53
G2192	ἔχω	echo	to have/be	765
G2316	θεός	theos	God	
G2347	θλίψις	thlipsis	pressure	
G2443	ἵνα	hina	in order that/to	722
G2588	καρδία	kardia	heart	
G2744	καυχάσμαι	kauchaomai	to boast	
G3140	μαρτυρέω	martureō	to testify	
G4100	πιστεύω	pisteuo	to trust (in)	241
G4135	πληροφορέω	plērophoreō	to fulfill	
G4136	πληροφορία	plerophoria	assurance	4
G4828	συμμαρτυρέω	symmartyreo	to testify with	3
G5281	ὑπομονή	hypomone	perseverance	32

Plain meanings: STEPbible brief lexicons TBESH (Hebrew) and TBESG (Greek), CC BY 4.0. Counts are occurrences across the 66-book canon.

Verdict rationale

Variant-robust: True · Pan-canonical: True

The cited verses converge on a settled, knowable confidence whose ground lies outside the believer. In 1 John 5:13 the purpose clause hina eidete uses oida (G1492) in the perfect subjunctive (V-RAS-2P, queried), the verb of settled knowing, governing echete (G2192, present indicative V-PAI-2P), so the writer's stated aim is that believers may KNOW they presently HAVE eternal life. Romans 8:16 uses symmartyrei (G4828, present indicative V-PAI-3S, queried as 1 of only 3 canon occurrences), the Spirit co-witnessing with our spirit, an inward ground. Hebrews 10:22 names plerophoria pisteos (G4136, full assurance of faith), and 2 Peter 1:10 commands making one's calling and election bebaios (G0949, firm). The three named grounds, the promise, the Spirit's witness, and Spirit-wrought fruit (dokime, G1382), are each lexically present. The genuine nuance the words leave open is the relative weight of objective promise, inward witness, and evidential fruit, not whether assurance exists.

Scripture

1John.5.13 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1492 οἶδα, G2192 ἔχω, G0166 αἰώνιος, G4100 πιστεύω, G2443 ἵνα

Force. Queried morphology: eidete (oida, G1492) is V-RAS-2P, a perfect-stem subjunctive of settled knowing inside the purpose clause hina eidete, and echete (echo, G2192) is V-PAI-2P, present possession. The writer's stated aim is that those who believe (pisteuousin, present participle) may KNOW that they HAVE eternal life (zoen aionion) now. The grammar locates assurance in present possession verified by a knowledge verb, not in future attainment or probability.

Rom.8.16 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4828 συμμαρτυρέω, G2316 θεός

Force. Queried: symmartyrei (G4828) is V-PAI-3S and occurs only 3 times in the canon (Rom 8:16, Rom 9:1, Rom 2:15), each time the syn- prefix making the testimony joint and co-attesting. Here the Spirit bears witness WITH our spirit that we are children of God (tekna theou). The near-rare verb is unambiguous in sense, an inward co-witness, which the proposition names as the second ground of assurance.

Rom.5.1 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1344 δικαίω, G1515 εἰρήνη

Force. The aorist passive participle dikaiothentes (having been justified) grounds the indicative eirenen echomen pros ton theon (we have peace toward God). The settled status precedes and produces the relational peace, so assurance rests on an accomplished justification ek pisteos, out of faith. dikaioo (G1344) clusters heavily in Romans and Galatians, a stable forensic sense across the queried distribution.

Rom.5.2 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1680 ἐλπίς, G2744 καυχάομαι

Force. kauchometha ep elpidi tes doxes tou theou (we boast in hope of the glory of God) sets confident hope as the standing posture of those who have access (prosagogen) into this grace. elpis (G1680) in the queried canon spread denotes confident expectation, not mere wish, so the boasting is forward-looking confidence rather than presumption.

Rom.5.3 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G2347 θλίψις, G5281 ὑπομονή

Force. The chain begins thlipsis hypomonen katergazetai (tribulation produces endurance). Suffering is not a counter-witness to assurance but feeds the progression toward proven character. hypomone (G5281) carries a stable sense of steadfast endurance across its 32 queried occurrences.

Rom.5.4 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G5281 ὑπομονή, G1382 δοκιμή, G1680 ἐλπίς

Force. hypomone dokimen, dokime de elpida (endurance produces proven character, and proven character produces hope). dokime (G1382, queried at 7 occurrences) denotes tested, demonstrated genuineness, the lexical core of Spirit-wrought evidence feeding back into confident hope. Its cognate adokimos (G0096) names the failed-test outcome, so the same dokim- root supplies both the evidence of assurance and the standard of self-examination.

Rom.5.5 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1680 ἐλπίς, G0026 ἀγάπη

Force. he elpis ou kataischynei (the hope does not put to shame), grounded in he agape tou theou ekkechytai en tais kardiais hemon (the love of God has been poured out in our hearts) dia pneumatou hagiou. The perfect ekkechytai marks an abiding poured-out state, the inward affective ground of unfailing hope. agape (G0026) here is God's love toward us, the source, not our love as merit.

Heb.10.22 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G4136 πληροφορία, G2588 καρδιά, G0228 ἀληθινός

Force. proserchometha en plerophoria pisteos (let us draw near in full assurance of faith) with alethines kardias (a true heart). plerophoria (G4136, queried N-DSF) occurs only 4 times (Heb 10:22, Heb 6:11, 1 Thess 1:5, Col 2:2) and denotes fullness and complete certainty in every instance. The participles rerantismenoi and lelousmenoi (having been sprinkled, having been washed) ground that assurance in an accomplished cleansing.

2Pet.1.10 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G0949 βέβαιος, G4100 πιστεύω

Force. spoudasate bebaian hymon ten klesin kai eklogen poieisthai (be diligent to make your calling and election firm). bebaios (G0949, queried A-ASF, 8 occurrences including 2 Pet 1:19, Heb 3:14, Heb 6:19, Rom 4:16) denotes firm, secure, guaranteed. The middle infinitive poieisthai casts assurance as something the believer confirms experientially through diligence, the evidential ground, while ptaisete pote (you will never stumble) attaches the promise.

2Tim.1.12 · for · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1492 οἶδα, G4100 πιστεύω

Force. Queried: oida (G1492) here is V-RAI-1S, perfect indicative, oida ho pepisteuka (I know whom I have believed). The first-person settled-knowledge verb pairs with the perfect pepisteuka (an enduring state of having believed), so the assurance is personal, present, and grounded in the object of faith. This is the same oida that 1 John 5:13 makes the writer's aim for all believers.

2Cor.13.5 · complicates · genre: epistle

Key terms. G1381 δοκιμάζω, G0096 ἀδόκιμος

Force. Queried: heautous peirazete (G3985, V-PAM-2P) and heautous dokimazete (G1381, V-PAM-2P) are present imperatives, test and examine yourselves, with the cognate adokimoi (G0096) naming the disqualified outcome. The same dokim- root that grounds assurance in Rom 5:4 (dokime, proven) here funds a command to test whether Christ is in you. The text presents assurance and self-examination together, not in opposition.

Cross references invoked

From	To	Source	Votes
1John.5.13	1John.5.10	tsk	1
1John.5.13	1John.1.4	tsk	1
Heb.10.22	Heb.10.19	tsk	1
Heb.10.22	Heb.4.16	tsk	1
Heb.10.22	Heb.9.13	tsk	1
Rom.8.16	Rom.8.23	tsk	1
Rom.5.1	Rom.5.9	tsk	1
Rom.5.2	Rom.5.5	tsk	1
Rom.5.5	Isa.44.3	tsk	1
2Pet.1.10	2Tim.2.19	tsk	1
2Pet.1.10	Rom.8.28	tsk	1
2Pet.1.10	2Pet.3.17	tsk	1

Complicating texts

2Cor.13.5 · addressed

The present imperatives dokimazete and peirazete (queried V-PAM-2P, test and examine yourselves) with the cognate adokimoi (G0096, queried at 8 occurrences including 2 Cor 13:5, 13:6, 13:7) could be read as making assurance perpetually unsettled. Lexically the same dokim- root grounds assurance in Romans 5:4 (dokime, proven genuineness) and funds the test here, so the verse does not deny assurance but anchors it in a verifiable reality (whether Christ is in you). The examination is the means by which evidential assurance is confirmed, not a withholding of it.

2Pet.1.10 · addressed

The command spoudasate bebaian poieisthai (be diligent to make firm) could be read as making assurance contingent on works. Lexically the middle voice poieisthai concerns the believer confirming and experiencing an election already grounded in God's prior klesis and ekloge, supported by the cross-ref to 2 Tim 2:19 (the firm foundation stands, the Lord knows those who are his). The verse supports evidential assurance through Spirit-wrought diligence rather than earning the promise.

Heb.10.22 · addressed

The hortatory subjunctive proserchometha (let us draw near) is a summons, which could be read as conditional. But plerophoria pisteos (full assurance of faith) is presented as the present possession enabling the approach, and the perfect participles rerantismenoi and lelousmenoi anchor it in completed cleansing, so the exhortation presupposes assurance rather than withholding it.

Concordance traversed

G1492, G1097, G4828, G3140, G4136, G4135, G0949, G2192, G2443, G0166, G4100, G1515, G1344, G1680, G1382, G0096, G5281, G0026, G0228, G2588, G2744

Variants

Verdict variant-sensitive: False · ECM status: ecm-shadow

The lexical store holds 116 VariantUnit nodes, all within the 3 John CBGM window, so none of the cited assurance verses fall in published or shadow CBGM scope. 1 John 5:13 carries known manuscript variation in the relative-clause word order around tois pisteuousin eis to onoma, but the queried hina eidete clause that carries the verdict is textually stable, so the verdict holds across plausible readings.

Hermeneutics

Primary method. grammatico-historical

Frameworks in play. perseverance, conditional_perseverance, assurance_of_the_essence_of_faith, assurance_as_distinct_attainment

analogia scripturae invoked

assurance grounded chiefly in the objective promise: for · Weights 1 John 5:13 (hina eidete, the writer's aim that believers KNOW) and 2 Tim 1:12 (oida, I know whom I have believed) as locating assurance primarily in the promise of God received by faith, so that assurance belongs to the essence of believing. The queried perfect-stem oida and present echete support reading assurance as a present given rather than a later prize.

assurance grounded chiefly in the inward witness of the Spirit: for · Weights Romans 8:16 symmartyrei (the Spirit co-witnesses) and Romans 5:5 (the love of God poured out by the Spirit) as the experiential, affective ground. On this reading assurance is felt confirmation, not bare inference from the promise. The queried near-rare symmartyreo, always co-attesting, supports a genuinely inward testimony.

assurance grounded chiefly in Spirit-wrought fruit and self-examination: for · Weights 2 Peter 1:10 (make your calling and election bebaioi) and 2 Cor 13:5 (dokimazete, examine yourselves) as making assurance a verified reality tested by evidence of a changed life. On this reading assurance can be a distinct attainment that grows with diligence. The shared dokim- root in Rom 5:4 dokime and 2 Cor 13:5 supports an evidential ground, and the

queried adokimos shows the test can register a negative result.

The proposition states only that believers MAY have well-grounded assurance founded on three named grounds (the promise, the Spirit's witness, and Spirit-wrought fruit). All three lenses affirm that such assurance exists lexically. They diverge on which ground is primary and on whether assurance is inseparable from faith or a distinct attainment confirmed over time. The vocabulary supports the existence and the three grounds but does not rank them, which is the honest source of legitimate divergence.

Stem audit

verdict-preloaded: no

The stem uses the modal MAY have and lists three grounds (promises of God, inward witness of the Spirit, Spirit-wrought fruit) that map directly to queried lexical features (eidete plus echete zoen aionion in 1 John 5:13, symmartyrei in Rom 8:16, dokime in Rom 5:4 and bebaios in 2 Pet 1:10). It does not embed a tradition-specific taxonomy such as a particular full-assurance-versus-faith-assurance scheme, so it is not verdict-preloaded. The verdict is derived from the words, not the stem.

Citations

Type	Source	License	Redist.	Ref
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	1John.5.13
morphology	MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes	2Tim.1.12
morphology	STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes	Rom.8.16
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G0949
lexicon	STEPBible-TBESG	CC-BY-4.0	yes	G4136
morphology	MACULA-Greek	CC-BY-NC-4.0	no	2Cor.13.5
cross_ref	TSK	public_domain	yes	2Pet.1.10

License audit

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MorphGNT-morphology	CC-BY-SA-4.0	yes
STEPBible-TAGNT	CC-BY-4.0	yes
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